

The Four Lost Days

Les quatre jours perdus

An extract from the Book of Enoch, prepared for the PAIX game world. Every claim below is marked. [R] is record, verifiable at the source cited. [A] is my reading and is not history. Scripture is quoted verbatim from a public-domain translation.

I Why this book

[R]

A book was lost and came back. That is the whole reason it is here.

1 Enoch was written in Aramaic. The Astronomical Book and the Book of the Watchers were already in circulation by the third century BC. By the fifth century AD it had been mostly excluded from Christian biblical canons in the West, and for something on the order of thirteen hundred years Europe did not have it. [1]

It was not lost everywhere. The Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church held it whole and continuously in Ge'ez, where it is Scripture, as it is for the Eritrean Orthodox Tewahedo Church and for the Beta Israel. [1] In 1773 James Bruce came back from six years in Abyssinia with three Ge'ez copies — one to the Bodleian, one to the royal library of France, one he kept. [2] Richard Laurence published the first English translation in 1821. [1]

Then, from 1948, eleven Aramaic manuscripts came out of Cave 4 at Qumran — 4Q201 through 4Q212, with 4Q208 to 4Q211 carrying the Astronomical Book, the oldest witnesses of all, dated to the late third and early second century BC. [3] They matched what the Ethiopians had been carrying the whole time.

[A]

Europe lost the book. An African church kept it. When it finally came back, the desert produced the original and the copies held up.

A record does not die because the people who wrote it were scattered. It dies when nobody keeps reading it. That is the same sentence as Chapter 2 of the game, What We Kept [4] — and it is why this book, and not another, belongs in the world we are building.

II What the game takes

[R]

One section only: the Astronomical Book, 1 Enoch 72–82, also called the Book of the Heavenly Luminaries. [1] It is a calendar. It contains no monsters.

1 Enoch 72:1–3 — [R]

“The book of the courses of the luminaries of the heaven ... which Uriel, the holy angel, who was with me, who is their guide, showed me ... And I saw six portals in which the sun rises, and six portals in which the sun sets and the moon rises and sets in these portals, and the leaders of the stars and those whom they lead: six in the east and six in the west, and all following each other.” [5]

1 Enoch 82:5–6 — [R]

“Owing to them men shall be at fault and not reckon them in the whole reckoning of the year: yea, men shall be at fault, and not recognize them accurately. For they belong to the reckoning of the year and are truly recorded (thereon) for ever, one in the first portal and one in the third, and one in the fourth and one in the sixth, and the year is completed in three hundred and sixty-four days.” [5]

The mechanic

[A]

Twelve gates. Four days that people stopped counting. Three hundred and sixty-four.

The game is not a fight. The game is: find the four days nobody counted, and put them back. There is no enemy to defeat at the end of that. Something gets completed, and the thing that completes it is arithmetic a child can do.

Four lost days gives us four chapters. What We Kept is already one of them — a people scattered who kept the count anyway. It does not need to be rewritten to fit. It was always this.

III Where it joins Filters of the Sun

[A]

Filters of the Sun says a source too large to receive whole gets sectioned, and the receiver fuses the sections back into one world. Two eyes. A gnomon. A pinhole. A kamal.

1 Enoch 72:3 sections the sun into twelve gates and has the year fuse them back into one course. It is the same instrument, written down roughly twenty-three centuries earlier. The Hyperloop is a line of gates. The year is a line of gates. There is no adaptation to do here — the door was already the shape of the door.

IV The message it carries

[R]

Three passages. All of them peace. None of them frightening. R. H. Charles's translation, public domain, quoted verbatim. [6]

1 Enoch 5:7 — [R]

“But for the elect there shall be light and joy and peace, and they shall inherit the earth.” [6]

1 Enoch 10:17–18 — [R]

“And then shall all the righteous escape, and shall live till they beget thousands of children, and all the days of their youth and their old age shall they complete in peace. And then shall the whole earth be tilled in righteousness, and shall all be planted with trees and be full of blessing.” [6]

1 Enoch 11:2 — [R]

“And truth and peace shall be associated together throughout all the days of the world and throughout all the generations of men.” [6]

[A]

That last line is PAIX. Truth and peace joined, all the days, all the generations. We did not invent it as a slogan and we do not have to defend it as one — it is a sentence out of a book older than the calendar it describes. It is the line the game closes on.

V What is deliberately left out

[R]

1 Enoch has five sections. [1] The game uses one.

- Book of the Watchers, chapters 1–36 — Watchers, Nephilim, the descent. Not used.
- Book of Parables, 37–71 — not used.
- Book of Dream Visions, 83–90 — not used.
- Epistle of Enoch, 91–108 — not used.
- Astronomical Book, 72–82 — this is the extract.

One passage is worth naming precisely because we are not using it. 1 Enoch 1:9 is quoted almost word for word in the New Testament, at Jude 14–15. [1] It is the single passage every tradition already accepts — and it is a judgement passage. We record that it exists and we leave it on the shelf.

[A]

A child should not have to be frightened in order to be taught something true.

And there is a plainer reason. The frightening material is the material the book gets argued over. Nobody argues about the calendar. Take the part that builds and leave the part that fights — the part that builds is also the part that is hardest to take away from you.

VI The cross, quietly

[A]

The four uncounted days sit at the four turns of the year: one in the first portal, one in the third, one in the fourth, one in the sixth. [5] Draw the year as a circle and mark them, and they fall at the quarters.

In the game that shape is not an instrument of death and it is not anybody's banner. It is four days a people forgot to count, and the player hands them back. The child restores four points on a circle and the shape comes up under their own hand.

Nothing has to be said out loud. Nobody has to be afraid of what came before in order to see it.

VII What we do not claim

[R]

- 1 Enoch is not in the Catholic canon. By the fifth century it was mostly excluded from Christian biblical canons in the West. It is canonical Scripture in the Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo and Eritrean Orthodox Tewahedo Churches and for the Beta Israel. [1] Both halves of that sentence are stated in the game.

- The extract is presented as heritage and astronomy, not doctrine. Nothing in it is taught as an article of faith, and no catechetical claim rests on it.
- The 364-day year is a historical calendar shown as history. We do not propose it replace any calendar in use.
- Uriel is named in the quoted text because the text names him. He is not a character, a guide, or a mechanic in the game.
- Translation: R. H. Charles, Oxford, public domain. Quotations are verbatim and unedited except for marked elision.
- The PAIX Church review gate and doctrinal-conformance requirement apply before parishioner release. This extract is submitted to that gate, not around it.

Dany Thériault · Lenexa, Kansas · 25 July 2026

En français

Un livre a été perdu, puis retrouvé. C'est toute la raison de sa présence ici. Écarté des canons chrétiens d'Occident dès le cinquième siècle, le Livre d'Hénoch a été gardé entier, en ge'ez, par l'Église orthodoxe éthiopienne téwahedo, où il est Écriture. Bruce en rapporte trois copies en 1773 ; Qumrân en rendra l'araméen à partir de 1948, et les copies concordent. [R]

Le jeu n'en prend qu'une section : le livre astronomique, 1 Hénoch 72–82. Douze portes ; quatre jours que les hommes ont cessé de compter ; trois cent soixante-quatre. La partie ne consiste pas à vaincre : elle consiste à retrouver les quatre jours et à les rendre. Les Veilleurs, les Néphilim et le jugement restent dehors — un enfant n'a pas à avoir peur pour apprendre quelque chose de vrai. [A]

Et la phrase que porte l'extrait, 1 Hénoch 11:2 : « la vérité et la paix seront unies pour tous les jours du monde et pour toutes les générations des hommes. » C'est PAIX. [R]

SOURCES

- [1] Book of Enoch — canon, sections, transmission, Jude 14–15. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Book_of_Enoch
- [2] A. Hessayon, James Bruce and his copies of Ethiopic Enoch, Goldsmiths. https://research.gold.ac.uk/id/eprint/33264/3/09_Hessayon_Enoch_01_copyedited.pdf
- [3] H. Drawnel, Qumran Cave 4: The Aramaic Books of Enoch, 4Q201–4Q212, Oxford. WorldCat record
- [4] PAIX / EVE Hyperloop game, Chapter 2 What We Kept. <https://eveglyphdesign.github.io/eve-hyperloop/game/>
- [5] 1 Enoch 72, 82 — R. H. Charles trans., public domain. https://www.ccel.org/c/charles/otpseudepig/enoch/ENOCH_3.HTM
- [6] 1 Enoch 5, 10, 11 — R. H. Charles trans., public domain. https://www.ccel.org/c/charles/otpseudepig/enoch/ENOCH_1.HTM

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